

Jelly Studio — Invite-Only Public Beta: Findings & Launch Plan

Prepared for Jared · August 15, 2026 · tolley.io/animate

THE ONE-PARAGRAPH VERSION

A 15-agent read-only research swarm — 12 finders plus 3 adversarial verifiers, ~1.5M tokens across 613 tool calls — went through `/animate` end to end on Aug 15. The verdict: **the product is real and the price is right, but the door is unlocked**. Trey Vater has paid for **24 videos**; the render quality is proven; and at **compute-at-cost + \$0.35 per finished minute** you land **2–4.5× cheaper per minute than TubeGen** with no subscription — a gap nobody in the faceless-video market is selling into. What you cannot do is send an invite today. Seven security findings are verifier-confirmed, and one of them lets **anyone with a single POST claim your admin account**. There is also a live Stripe path armed at the *old* ~\$25/video pricing that has never been tested and would fire on the first user who adds a card. **Phase 1 closes all of it in a day**. After that, the plan is four phases and roughly a week to a working invite-only beta with prepaid credits, per-video receipts, and legal pages that actually mention the product.

7

Verifier-confirmed security findings, incl. **account takeover on the admin email**. All block invites.

\$0.31/min

Net margin at cost + \$0.35/min after Stripe. A **flat \$0.35** loses money on 17 of the last 20 videos.

2–4.5×

Cheaper per finished minute than TubeGen (\$1.94–2.47/min), with no cap and no subscription.

+\$210/mo

Realistic beta net at 5 users × 30 min/wk. Break-even ≈ **178 min/mo** against ~\$55 fixed.

THREE ANSWERS, UP FRONT

A Can you ship it?

Yes — after Phase 1

The product works and the economics work. But the **public golden path has never been run end-to-end by anyone** — the audit harness fakes every POST, and only Trey has projects. **Nothing goes out until the lockdown ships and one real signup-to-render runs clean.**

B What does it cost you?

≤ \$100

Cash exposure for **\$10 promo credit × 10 invitees** in stills mode (~\$0.45/min all-in), not \$300. Card on file via SetupIntent, **no \$0.50 charge**. GTM adds \$150 starter credits + \$150 Meta test.

C What do you have to buy?

Nothing

Five users needs **zero hardware** — a render semaphore and Modal-only defaults. Ten to fifteen needs **Modal Team, \$250/mo**. A second GB10 adds **zero** /animate capacity, because Vater is Modal-only.

Read page 3 before you send a single invite. Open signup plus an admin email with no credentials on file means the takeover is one unauthenticated request away — and today's job, voice, and billing endpoints leak across tenants to any signed-in account. These are not theoretical: each was independently re-confirmed by a verifier agent against live code.

The six decisions, locked

Agreed with Jared on Aug 15, 2026. Everything downstream in this brief is built on these — the plan does not re-open them.

- 1 Price = compute at cost + \$0.35 per finished minute — for everyone**
Model B, the same deal Trey is on. Stripe's 2.9% + \$0.30 is grossed into the pack prices rather than charged on top. This is the only version of the pricing that is profitable on your real render history.
- 2 \$10 free starter credit per invitee, card on file first**
Collected with a Stripe **SetupIntent** — \$0, not the \$0.50 verification charge. Promo credit is stills-mode only; animation requires purchased credits.
- 3 Stay on toley.io/animate — alias only after 5 paying users**
cordport.io is **not idle**: it serves the live CordPort marketplace with three crons. Do not reposit it. `studio.tolley.io` is unassigned and free to alias later.
- 4 ToS reuse clause = showcase + product improvement, with an opt-out toggle**
Modelled on Suno's "operating, improving, promoting" and Midjourney's survives-termination language, with a per-user opt-out switch.
- 5 Trey scoped to his own projects**
He keeps every feature plus Zelle / unmetered billing, via a DB flag instead of a see-everything tier. The **208 legacy null-owner projects** get assigned to Jared.
- 6 GTM budget = \$150 starter credits + \$150 Meta test**
From a new "Jelly Studio" Facebook Page under your existing Meta Business account, on Jared's ad account. **Jared sends every DM and every post** — nothing customer-facing goes out automatically.

The verdict

Ship it — in four phases, in this order, and not a day sooner than Phase 1's completion. **Phase 1 (day 1)** locks the doors: no invite goes out while account takeover, cross-tenant reads and unmetered free renders are live. **Phase 2 (days 2–4)** makes money real — a prepaid credit ledger, a debit at render finish, a per-video receipt. **Phase 3 (days 3–6)** makes it a beta program: invite codes, password reset, click-wrap ToS, legal pages, feedback capture, a version pill, read-only view-as, a per-user system log. **Phase 4 (days 4–7)** makes it sellable: a rewritten landing page with real demos, one honest price everywhere, mobile fixes, GTM kit.

Realistic beta economics — 5 users at 30 finished minutes a week (650 min/mo), priced at compute + \$0.35/min, against ~\$55/mo of fixed cost

≈ **+\$210/mo**

The one number that changes the model: a *flat* \$0.35/min all-in **loses money on 17 of the last 20 videos**. Blended all-time on Trey's account is **\$1.35/min all-in** (32 videos, 108.5 min, \$146.76); recent long-form runs \$0.51–0.90/min. Cost-plus is the difference between a margin and a subsidy.

Also armed right now: the old per-action Stripe path in `lib/vater/pricing.ts` is wired to a **live key** and has never been tested. The first user to add a card would get InvoiceItems at roughly **\$25/video** — contradicting the ~\$3 the library card shows them. Phase 1 puts it behind a default-off flag before anything else touches Stripe.

A0 · Security — fix before any invite goes out

Every item below was independently re-confirmed by an adversarial verifier agent against live code. These are ordered by how much damage a stranger with a browser can do.

1 · Account takeover on the admin email. `app/api/auth/register/route.ts:62-77` attaches a new password to **any existing User that has no credentials**. The owner's admin address sits on both the admin and vater-owner allowlists, has **zero credentials**, and MFA is unenforced — so a single unauthenticated POST claims it. This is the finding that makes "just send a few invites" impossible today.

2 · Cross-tenant job leak. `GET /api/vater/pipeline-status` returns **every user's** jobIds, projectIds, and lastLog to any signed-in account. `GET /api/vater/autopilot/jobs/[jobId]` then proxies the whole job — script, prompts, costs, finalVideoUrl. Any invitee could read every other customer's work in two requests.

3 · Voice library wide open. `DELETE /api/vater/voices/[id]` and `GET /voices/[id]/sample` need only a session — any signup can **delete or download** your and Monroe's voice clones. `GET /api/vater/voices` lists all **22 clones**, including Jared-A through Jared-D.

4 · Free unmetered renders, and a self-inflicted outage. `POST /api/vater/topic` has no `checkBudget`, and all **17 system styles** default to `firered-local + f5-tts`. So a public user's render runs **on the GB10**, calls `vater_runway.clear()` — which stops **17 production services** — and auto-starts `comfyui-vater`, violating the standing VATER = MODAL-ONLY rule.

5 · Studio tier sees and edits everything. `lib/vater/project-access.ts:33` returns an empty filter for studio emails; `GET /api/vater/direct` lists all Direct jobs; and `summary.ts:118` sums **all** projects into Trey's bill — so a second studio user would both see his work and distort his invoice.

6 · Model A Stripe path is armed and untested. Live key, `pricing.ts` per-action prices, **zero charges ever made** and zero subscription rows — meaning the first real card triggers an untested billing path at ~\$25/video against a UI promising ~\$3.

7 · The basics are missing. No login rate-limit. No password reset. JWTs valid **30 days with no revocation**. One shared ElevenLabs key — any user can drain your plan.

What this costs to fix: one day. Phase 1 on page 10 is nine concrete edits, all inside `~/tolley-site` except the render-semaphore change in `vater.py`. Nothing here needs new infrastructure and nothing here needs a decision from you.

The reassuring half: isolation between users is **data-only by design** — there are no per-user Modal apps, containers, or notebooks to get wrong. The leaks above are all missing `WHERE userId = ...` clauses and missing auth guards, not an architecture that has to be rebuilt.

A1 · Billing truth · A2 · Unit economics

What the system currently charges, what a minute of video actually costs, and where the money leaks.

A1 — Three prices coexist today

- The landing says "**~\$25/video**"; `lib/vater/pricing.ts` holds per-action Stripe pricing (armed, **0 charges ever, 0 VaterSubscription rows**); `ops-fee.ts / summary.ts` compute cost + **\$0.35/min** (report-only, Zelle). Three answers to "what does this cost" is two too many.
- No prepaid credit or balance concept exists for Vater** — but a proven prepaid-pack pattern *does* exist for `/video/studio` (`lib/stripe-webhook.ts:496-527 fulfillVideoCredits`, `STRIPE_PRICE_VIDEO_PACK_*`). Clone it.
- Stripe Billing Credits require metered subscriptions and add **0.7% per applied credit** — do not use them. Own the Prisma ledger and use Checkout in `mode: 'payment'`. (stripe.com/pricing)
- `ops-fee.ts:18` reads a DGX path that does not exist on Vercel, so the production rate is effectively a hardcoded 0.35 — move it to `VATER_OPS_RATE_PER_MIN`.
- Per-video receipt data (compute, ops, minutes) **already exists** on the cards and lightbox; render wall-time is shown nowhere.

Stripe gross-up — what a credit pack must actually cost

Formula: `gross = (net + 0.30) / 0.971`. Or sell round packs and absorb the fee with bonus credits.

CREDIT VALUE THE USER RECEIVES	PRICE TO CHARGE	STRIPE KEEPS	ROUND-PACK ALTERNATIVE
\$10 starter pack	\$10.61	\$0.61	\$10 → 9.43 credits
\$25	\$26.06	\$1.06	\$25 → 23.98 credits
\$50	\$51.80	\$1.80	\$50 → 48.25 credits
\$100	\$103.30	\$3.30	\$100 → 96.80 credits

A2 — What a finished minute really costs

MEASURE	VALUE	WHY IT MATTERS
Stills-only long-form compute	\$0.16–0.55/min median ~\$0.29	The headline cost — but not the true one.
True all-in, stills	~\$0.45/min	After unbooked Modal TTS (+\$0.06) and drift (+\$0.12). Use this for exposure math.
Animated minutes	\$2.70–4.00/min	Six to nine times stills. Promo credits must not fund it.
All-time blended (Trey)	\$1.35/min all-in	32 videos, 108.5 min, \$146.76 total.
Recent long-form	\$0.51–0.90/min all-in	The trend is down — the pipeline is getting cheaper.
Flat \$0.35/min all-in	Loses money	On 17 of the last 20 videos. Cost-plus is the only profitable version.
Margin at cost + \$0.35	≈ \$0.31/min	After Stripe fees.

Repairs are the margin killer. Video #21 went from **\$1.87 to \$22.90 — 12×** — **via 496 re-rolls**. An uncapped repair loop can turn any single video into a month of margin. Phase 2 caps re-rolls at ~15% of scenes and prices the rest.

On "5 clients × 500 hrs/day": that is **150,000 minutes a day** — about **130 H100s running 24/7**, and ~20× more video than there are hours in a day. Not a real scenario. The realistic beta is **5 users × 30 min/wk = 650 min/mo**, break-even near **178 min/mo** against ~\$55 fixed. Separately: the Modal workspace already runs **~\$600/mo** across all lanes (Aug MTD **\$339**), and the Starter budget cap **halts every app** when hit — beta users would fail silently. Raise the alert before invites. (modal.com/pricing)

A3 · Price position · A4 · Length & quality

Where Jelly sits in the market, and what the render history says a beta is allowed to promise.

A3 — The competitive board, per finished minute

PRODUCT	EFFECTIVE \$/MIN	TERMS	THE CATCH
Jelly Studio (proposed)	\$0.55–0.95	No subscription, prepaid credits	Beta, invite-only, 9:00 cap.
TubeGen	\$1.94–2.47	\$149 / \$297 / \$849 per month	No trial, no refunds, 30-min max, voice clones Pro+ only.
Vidnoz	\$1.33–1.80	Subscription	60-minute maximum.
Argil	~\$1.50	Subscription	—
StoryShort	\$0.58–1.56	Subscription	—
NoLang	\$0.76–1.00	Subscription	3-minute cap.
Zebrecat	\$0.25–0.50	Subscription	Only at 100% quota utilisation, and a 5-minute cap.
Faceless.so	n/a	Subscription	Shorts only — not a long-form competitor.

The gap: nobody sells per-finished-minute with no subscription, and nobody markets a named anti-slop feature in the faceless segment. That is the position — and price alone is not the moat. Per-minute honesty, generated scenes, and a cloned voice are.

Feature parity — what the page may honestly claim

CLAIM THESE — THEY EXIST

- Script writer
- Custom voice clone + Voice Tuner studio-only today
- Library
- 7-step editor
- Upload ≤ 10 MB
- YouTube publish studio-only today
- Automation owner-only

DO NOT CLAIM — REAL GAPS

- Visible thumbnail generator
- Auto title / description / timestamps

Two of the "exists" rows are gated to the studio tier right now. Phase 3 ungates voice clone and YouTube publish for card-on-file users — claim them on the page only once that ships.

A4 — What the render history actually supports

- Shipped clean at 8:38–8:44 four times (#15, #18, #19, #20, #22). #19 — 8:44, \$5.56 all-in — is the approved benchmark.
- The only video over 9:00 (#21, 15:12, 228 scenes) failed QA on 63 scenes, because the re-roll budget is a fixed 20 regardless of length. Hence: beta hard cap 9:00, soft default 5:00, reject scripts over 1,700 words.
- Scenes are uniformly ~4.0 s (≈15 scenes per finished minute) in every approved render, but the site path defaults to 5.0 s (vater.py:3125) — pin it to 4 s. Animated clips are 81 frames ≈ 5 s, clamped 2–8 s.
- Wall-clock: 7–10 minutes per finished minute stills-only — the planner LLM alone is 32 minutes of a 51-minute job, the single biggest stage. Animated runs ~23 min per finished minute.
- Guardrail rules for all users: 7, 19, 26–28, 31/137, 41, 42/129, 48/133, 62–66, 70, 91–97 plus positive-only headcount. Trey-only: 12–13, 23–34, 36, 38, 45, 49, 52–54, 58–59, 89, 120–136.
- Demo candidates: #19 (8:44), #23 (3:24 — Jared's own script, usable now), #22 (8:38), #16 (0:29 teaser). All except #23 need Trey's written consent. Today the landing has no demo videos at all — only a fake CSS card reading "\$24.85".

A5 · Onboarding, auth & isolation · A6 · Capacity

What a tenth user would actually experience today, and what breaks first when they all render at once.

A5 — The onboarding reality

- Signup is **fully open** (`/signup?callbackUrl=/animate`): no invite code, no email verification, no password reset. Tiers are Vercel **environment-variable allowlists** — every new user is an edit plus a redeploy.
- **The public golden path has never been run end-to-end by anyone.** The audit harness fakes all POSTs, and Trey is the only account with projects. Nobody has actually walked `signup` → `style` → `project` → `render` → `download`.
- Good news on infrastructure: a new user needs **no Modal app, container, or notebook**. Modal apps are shared, containers are per-call, the DGX runs one shared orchestrator. Isolation is **data-only (userId)** — which is exactly why the A0 leaks matter so much.
- **Voices and characters are flat shared directories** on the DGX keyed by name (`vater_voices/` , `~/vater-studio/characters`) — **user #2 collides with user #1**. Namespacing is a Phase 3 item.
- No impersonation or view-as exists. No feedback capture beyond a mailto link. No version or changelog. **No error tracker** — `log.ts` is a production no-op.
- Publishing: per-user YouTube OAuth exists but the start route is studio-gated (**403 for public users**). Every other platform is a stub.

A6 — What the stack can carry

USERS	WHAT IT NEEDS	DETAIL
5 users <code>buy nothing</code>	Render semaphore + Modal-only style defaults	Today's stack already serves ~5 users at 30 finished min/day with queueing.
10–15 users	Modal Team — \$250/mo , 50 GPUs + semaphore + <code>max_workers</code> 4–6	Parallelism, not hardware. Decision gets queued once concurrency passes 4.
A second GB10	Do not buy for this	Adds zero <code>/animate</code> capacity — Vater is Modal-only. Buy it for other reasons or not at all.

The concurrency ceiling right now: `vater.py` spawns an **unbounded thread per render** with no semaphore, while Modal Starter allows **10 concurrent GPUs workspace-wide** — shared with the Lady and shorts lanes. That works out to **3–4 simultaneous Vater renders** today. The DGX side of the job is CPU (ffmpeg, whisper) and RAM: **27 GB free with swap at 86%**.

Two observability gaps that will bite during a beta: per-user logs are not durable (a **30-line ring buffer** and a **40-job prune**), so a user's failure is gone before you can look at it. And the LLM cost meter is **process-wide**, so it mis-attributes spend across concurrent users — which quietly corrupts per-video receipts the moment two people render at once. Phase 1 makes the meter per-job; Phase 3 adds the durable `VaterEvent` log.

Onboarding is genuinely turnkey once styles default to Modal. There are zero DGX steps and zero Modal steps for a new user — the entire "how do I set this person up" answer becomes: mint an invite code, they sign up, they add a card, they get \$10.

A7 · Go-to-market — where the first five come from

Ranked by cost per actual paying user, not by reach. Jared pulls every trigger; nothing customer-facing sends itself.

The ranked channel plan

1

Trey referrals + warm DMs target: 2 paying

Free, warmest, and already validated — he is the one person who has paid you for this. Ask for **3 referrals** in the same conversation as the demo-consent sign-off.

2

Organic demo clips — TikTok @digitaljared, 30.3K target: 1–2

\$0. Three demo clips a week. The audience already exists; the product has never been shown to it.

3

\$150 Meta traffic test — new Jelly Studio Page target: ~1

Reels + Feed, \$10–15/day, landing on an invite-request page. B2B SaaS cost per lead runs **\$80–\$380**, so \$150 buys **1–2 leads** — treat it as a test of the funnel, not a growth channel.

4

Faceless-creator Discords — DM-for-invite target: 1

[Faceless Incubator \(37.9K\)](#) and YouTube Faceless (21.4K). Rules-compliant posts, invite by DM.

5

Build-in-public — [r/SideProject](#) + [r/SaaS](#)

Free. The per-minute pricing story is the post; the honest cost breakdown is the hook.

6

Product Hunt + Show HN — week 2

Free. Hold until the landing page has real demo videos and the golden path has been walked by a stranger.

7

Fiverr done-for-you gig, \$35–60

Generates **cash, not signups**. Useful for validating what people will pay per video; it does not build the beta.

Channels ruled out: Google Ads at **\$8.50–14 CPC** is too expensive to test at this budget. **BetaList is \$39 with a 4–6 week queue** — too slow for an Aug 31 goal. **AppSumo is structurally incompatible**, since lifetime deals cannot work against per-minute compute cost. And the Instantly cold-email lane is killed — reviving it would need a new sender.

Meta requires AI-generated creative to be labelled — unlabelled AI creative accounted for **14% of 2026 rejections**. Lady and Ruthann outputs are usable as ad creative today; **Vater outputs only after Trey signs the consent**.

Multi-platform hand-off — the scheduler question

OPTION	COST	API?	VERDICT
Postiz , self-hosted on the DGX	\$0	Yes	The pick — Docker on hardware you already run.
Blotato	\$29/mo	Yes	The no-ops fallback if self-hosting stalls.
Repurpose.io	\$35/mo per creator	No API	Drive-folder watch only — not automatable.
Ayrshare	\$149–599/mo	Yes	Priced for a platform, not a five-user beta.

A8 · Legal · A9 · Domain & brand

The paperwork gap is real but small — and the pattern for closing it already exists in this codebase.

Today there is no legal coverage for /animate at all. /terms and /privacy are T-Agent / SMS pages dated February 2024 that never mention the product. Nothing records ToS acceptance for /animate users — there is no termsAcceptedAt , and Trey has no acceptance on file either.

The fix is a known pattern. The estate lane already proved per-brand legal pages: lib/legal-estate.ts plus app/estate/terms|privacy . Phase 3 clones it as lib/legal-animate.ts + app/animate/terms|privacy|beta through the shared components/legal/legal-page-shell.tsx .

Clauses the beta must have

- **User owns their outputs** — stated plainly, first.
- **Showcase + improvement licence with an opt-out** — modelled on Suno's "operating, improving, promoting" and Midjourney's survives-termination wording (decision #4).
- **Beta AS-IS, no SLA** — on its own /animate/beta addendum page.
- **Voice-clone consent attestation** — Tennessee ELVIS Act, California §3344, New York §§50–51.
- **Credit expiry:** prepaid credits non-refundable; **purchased credits do not expire** (or 12 months); **promo credits 30–60 days**.
- **YouTube API Services block** — Google policy III.A, reproduced verbatim; required by their terms.
- **Subprocessor list** — Modal, Kimi / Moonshot (China), fal, Gemini, ElevenLabs. The China disclosure is not optional.
- **Blob finals are public-unlisted URLs** — disclose it; users assume otherwise.
- **TAKE IT DOWN Act** — a 48-hour removal path.

Entity, tax and registration

ITEM	STATUS	DETAIL
Entity	settled	Your KC Homes LLC (Missouri).
Sales tax	later	Missouri does not tax SaaS. Pennsylvania does, at 6–8% — register when PA nexus arrives with the move.
DMCA agent	\$6, do it	Registration at dmca.copyright.gov. Six dollars buys the safe-harbour defence.
Attorney review	~\$300	One hour on the arbitration and showcase clauses. Optional before beta, sensible before scale.

A9 — Domain and brand

- **cordport.io serves the live CordPort marketplace** with three crons — **do not repoint it**. This was the single biggest factual correction the swarm made to the original plan.
- **studio.tolley.io** is **unassigned in DNS** and free to alias later. Note that auth cookies are host-only, so aliasing needs an AUTH_URL per host.
- "Jelly Studio" collides with **Jellysmack's JellyStudio** (video-editing gigs) and a Jelly AI editor. Fine for a beta — **do not buy domains or file a trademark yet**.

The landing page currently lies in three places. It has no demo videos, no ToS or privacy links, no beta badge and no version — while promising "NO CARD REQUIRED" and "~\$25/video". Both are wrong under the new model: the beta requires a card on file, and a typical long-form video costs the user \$1–7. Phase 4 rewrites it.

Part B · Direct answers to your questions

Every question you asked, answered from measured data rather than estimate — length, pricing, capacity, distribution, and the contradictions that needed settling.

YOUR QUESTION	THE ANSWER
Long-form: what is a typical safe length? Have we cracked 9 minutes?	Clean up to 8:44 , five times. The one 15:12 attempt failed QA . Beta hard cap 9:00 , default 5:00 ; going past 9 minutes needs the re-roll budget to scale with scene count first.
How long is each segment?	~ 4 s for stills scenes (~15 per finished minute); animated clips ~5 s. Pin 4 s site-wide — the site path currently defaults to 5 s.
Can we show the cost breakdown?	Yes . Per-video receipt = compute at cost, broken out by stage + minutes × \$0.35 + total + render wall-time. Balance ledger visible to the user; margin visible only to you .
Is \$0.35/min plus Stripe fees accounted for?	Model is compute at cost + \$0.35/min ; packs are grossed up so Stripe's 2.9% + \$0.30 is recovered rather than eaten. Net margin ≈ \$0.31/min .
Can I sign up 10 people with their own logins, and does the email link work?	Signup works but is open and unsafe . Ship invite codes, starter credit and password reset first — then yes: each gets their own login, projects and balance.
Can I log in as them without their password?	Not today . Phase 3 ships read-only view-as — an HMAC cookie honoured only for admin emails, audit-logged, red banner, all writes blocked.
How do we label it a beta and collect feedback?	Beta badge in the nav and hero, a Beta Addendum page , and an in-app Feedback control that files to /hq Must Complete and pings Telegram.
Where do we ship and advertise it, and what does it cost to use?	tolley.io/animate ; channels ranked on page 7. Users pay roughly \$1–7 per long-form video (\$0.35/min + \$0.15–0.55/min compute).
Can I get a system log per user, quarantine them, and stop cross-viewing?	Yes — a VaterEvent table plus a System Log screen, A0 leaks closed, per-user voice and character namespaces , Trey scoped to his own work.
What about terms of service and privacy?	New /animate/terms , /animate/privacy and /animate/beta per page 8, with click-wrap on signup and a re-prompt for existing users.
Does Modal run on my account per new user — does each need a new container or notebook?	No . Modal apps are shared and containers are per-call. Onboarding involves zero DGX and zero Modal steps once the styles default to Modal backends.
Does the DGX have capacity for 5, 10 or 15 users?	5 : nothing to buy — semaphore plus Modal defaults. 10–15 : Modal Team at \$250/mo plus parallelism. Never a second GB10 for this workload.
What about the domain — should we use cordport.io?	No — it is live . Stay on toley.io/animate and leave CordPort alone. Alias <code>studio.tolley.io</code> once there are 5 paying users.
How do we handle versioning?	A v1.3 pill (Voice Tuner) in the header opening a changelog drawer, back-filled v1.0–1.3 from git. Rule: minor bump per shipped feature , entry in the same commit.
Is it usable on mobile?	Sidebar routes show zero overflow . Editor steps are unverified — extend the Playwright audit to the editor and fix three 1fr 1fr grids at 390 px.
Can users upload to all platforms — should we use Repurpose?	Ungate YouTube OAuth for card-on-file users; everyone else gets download + a "Send to scheduler" hand-off (Postiz self-hosted, \$0 , or Blotato \$29/mo). Repurpose has no API .
Is there a real market, and can we undercut it?	Yes. 2–4.5× cheaper than TubeGen per finished minute, with no cap or quota. But the moat is per-minute honesty, generated scenes and a cloned voice — not price alone.
Can we give free credits without it costing \$300?	Yes — ≤ \$100 . \$10 promo × 10 invitees at stills-mode cost (~\$0.45/min). Card on file via SetupIntent , no \$0.50 charge .
The contradictions — settled	Pricing → cost + \$0.35/min. The \$0.50 verification charge → dropped. cordport.io → live, keep it. "500 hrs/day" → physically impossible, discard. Free-tier copy vs card-on-file → rewrite the copy. Trey sees everything → scope him to his own projects.

Part C · Execution plan

Four phases over roughly a week. Phase 1 is a hard gate — no invite leaves the building until every box on this page is ticked.

STEP 0 Deliverables first

same session

- ☐ Render Parts A + B + C as this blue/gold PDF at `public/research/jelly-beta-launch-2026-08.pdf`, page-fit checked, linked in the **/hq Docs menu**, deployed; TLDR to Telegram **as a link**.
- ☐ Write memory `jelly-beta-launch-plan-2026-08.md` — decisions, findings pointers, step list — plus its `MEMORY.md` index line.

PHASE 1 Lockdown — before any invite

day 1 · `~/tolley-site` unless noted

- ☐ **Kill the takeover.** `app/api/auth/register/route.ts:62-77` → return **409 when the User already exists** (never attach a credential); add `rateLimitByIp` to the Credentials `authorize` at `auth.ts:162`.
- ☐ **Scope every read.** `pipeline-status/route.ts` — filter `activeJobs` to the session's `projectIds` (studio/admin exempt only via `isVaterAdminEmail`); `autopilot/jobs/[jobId]/route.ts` — verify `YouTubeProject.autopilotJobId` ownership; `direct/route.ts:68` — filter by `createdByEmail`.
- ☐ **Close the voice library.** `voices/[id]/route.ts` DELETE plus `[id]/sample` and `[id]/tuning` → `requireVaterProxyAuth` and an ownership check; hide the personal Jared-A–D clones from non-owner listings via a `vater_voices/<Name>.private` marker on the DGX.
- ☐ **Meter the free path.** `app/api/vater/topic/route.ts` — add `checkBudget(userId, 'scene')` before `runCreation`, mirroring `approve-script/route.ts:58-63`.
- ☐ **Modal-only for non-owners.** `context/route.ts ~:303-356` — force `defaultQuality=firered-modal` and `voiceBackend=indextts-modal` unless `isVaterAdminEmail`; register `indextts-modal` in `lib/vater/style-snapshot.ts:84`, `lib/vater/autopilot-client.ts:164`, `StyleEditor*.tsx` and `StyleWizardModal.tsx:146`; migrate the **17 system YouTubeStyle rows** to the Modal backends.
- ☐ **Bound the render fan-out.** `~/content-autopilot/vater.py:_spawn` — `BoundedSemaphore` on `VATER_MAX_ACTIVE_RENDERERS=4`, plus one active render per project owner and a `queued (#N)` phase; make the LLM meter **per-job** (`vater.py:435-470`); book Modal TTS into `byStage` so it stops reporting as "local DGX — \$0"; H100 rate at `vater.py:418` → **0.001097** only alongside an overhead-multiplier re-tune (otherwise leave both alone).
- ☐ **Disarm Model A.** `record-usage.ts:77-102` — put the `Invoiceltem` branch behind `VATER_LEGACY_ACTION_BILLING=1`, default off. **Nothing posts to Stripe until the Phase 2 ledger is live.**
- ☐ **Fix isolation.** `lib/vater/project-access.ts:33` → studio sees only its own; add `VaterAccount {userId, tier, unmetered, invitedBy, notes}` read by `lib/admin-auth.ts` with the `env allowlist` as fallback; assign the **208 null-owner projects** to Jared's `userId`; `summary.ts:getVaterBillingSummary(userId)` and `VaterPayment.userId` so Trey's Zelle path keeps working — scoped.
- ☐ **Verify and ship.** `npx vercel env pull` before and after to diff the production allowlists; run the Playwright audit; deploy via branch → `main`.

Gate: Phase 1 is not "mostly done". Items 1–4 each independently allow a stranger to take the account, read other customers' work, delete your voice clones, or run free renders that stop 17 production services. **All nine ship together, then invites.**

Phase 2 · Prepaid credits & receipts

Days 2–4. Turns "we track it and settle by Zelle" into a real prepaid balance with a debit at render finish and a receipt the user can read.

PHASE 2 Money, made real

days 2–4

- ☐ **The ledger.** Prisma `VaterCreditLedger {userId, deltaCents, kind purchase|grant|debit|refund|adjust, projectId?, stripeSessionId?, lineJson}`. **Balance is the sum** — no separate balance column to drift out of sync.
- ☐ **The packs.** `POST /api/vater/billing/packs` → Stripe Checkout in `mode: 'payment'` at **\$10 / \$25 / \$50 / \$100**, grossed up or given bonus credits; `payment_intent_data.setup_future_usage` to keep the card. Webhook branch cloned from `lib/stripe-webhook.ts:496-527` `fulfillVideoCredits` **with event-id idempotency**; keep the `setup-mode` route for card-on-file.
- ☐ **The debit.** At `poll/route.ts:266-313` (status → ready) call `buildVideoBillingLine(costJson.totalUsd, audioDuration)` from `ops-fee.ts` and write a ledger debit. True-ups reconcile through the `scripts/vater-cost-reconcile.mjs:202` hook as `adjust`. **Failed renders never debit.** Cap repairs per video (re-rolls ≤ 15% of scenes) so no bill can 12× the way #21 did.
- ☐ **The gate.** `check-budget.ts` → check the unmetered flag, then require **balance ≥ estimate** (planned minutes × (\$0.35 + median compute \$0.45)); otherwise **402** and the `BillingBlockModal` offers "Buy credits".
- ☐ **The starter credit.** On invite accept with a card saved, **grant \$10** — promo kind, **60-day expiry, stills-mode only**. Animation requires purchased credits.
- ☐ **The receipt.** `GET /api/vater/youtube/[id]/receipt` — compute by stage, minutes, ops fee, total, and wall-time from a new `phaseTimings` — surfaced in the lightbox **for every tier**. The Billing screen shows balance + ledger + packs. Move the rate to `VATER_OPS_RATE_PER_MIN` in Vercel env.
- ☐ **Prove it before anyone pays.** Stripe **test-mode** key in `.env.local` plus `stripe listen`; run one complete **pack** → **webhook** → **render** → **debit** cycle. (Money-movement work here is explicitly authorised by decision #1.)

Why a Prisma ledger rather than Stripe Billing Credits: Stripe's credit product requires metered subscriptions — which decision #3 rules out — and charges an extra **0.7% on every applied credit**. Owning the ledger costs one table and gives you refunds, promo expiry, and reconciliation adjustments that Stripe's version does not model.

The good news on effort: almost nothing here is novel. The pack → webhook → fulfil path already runs in production for `/video/studio`, the cost math already runs in `ops-fee.ts`, and the per-video receipt data is already computed and displayed. Phase 2 is mostly **wiring three existing systems to each other** and adding the ledger they write to.

Do not skip the idempotency key. Stripe retries webhooks. A `fulfillVideoCredits` clone without event-id deduplication will credit a pack twice on any retry — and unlike a double charge, a double credit is invisible until the margin is already gone.

Phase 3 · Beta program surfaces

Days 3–6. Everything that turns a working renderer into something ten strangers can be handed a login to.

PHASE 3 Invites, legal, logs, view-as

days 3–6

- ☐ **Invites.** `BetaInvite {code, email?, maxUses, usedCount, expiresAt}; require /signup?callbackUrl=/animate&invite=CODE`. A /hq "Studio users" card mints codes, flips tier and unmetered, and shows balance and last error.
- ☐ **Password reset.** `VerificationToken` already exists — add `/reset-password` and wire SMTP env or Resend. Note the send-email allowlist **blocks unknown recipients by default**: add invitee domains, or `*` for transactional mail.
- ☐ **Click-wrap.** `User.termsAcceptedAt / termsVersion / showcaseOptOut`; a checkbox on animate signup; re-prompt existing users — including Trey, who has nothing on file.
- ☐ **Legal pages.** `lib/legal-animate.ts + app/animate/terms|privacy|beta` via `components/legal/legal-page-shell.tsx`; footer and landing links; **DMCA agent registration (\$6)** queued to Jared; voice-consent checkbox writing `voiceConsentAt` on upload.
- ☐ **Feedback.** HelpDrawer "Report a problem / Feedback" → `POST /api/vater/feedback` → a `MustCompleteItem` (source `animate-feedback`, carrying route, `projectId`, `APP_VERSION`, user agent) + `notifyTelegram()`, with a **ticket id returned to the user**.
- ☐ **Versioning.** `lib/vater/changelog.ts` with `APP_VERSION='1.3'` and entries: **v1.0** (6/11 PPV launch), **v1.1** (8/5–8 studio tier, Blob library, Script Review), **v1.2** (8/9–13 Course, Direct, #N numbering, settlement-based due), **v1.3** (8/15 role-aware nav + mobile, Voice Tuner). Header pill opens a "What's new" section in the HelpDrawer with an unread dot.
- ☐ **View-as.** `POST /api/admin/vater/view-as` sets `jelly_view_as=<uid>.<iat>.<hmac(AUTH_SECRET)>` — same pattern as `wd_admin` — honoured in the `auth.ts` session callback **only for admin emails, read-only** (blocked on POST/PATCH/DELETE and on billing), writing an `AdminImpersonation` audit row, with a red "Viewing as X" bar.
- ☐ **Per-user system log.** `VaterEvent {userId, projectId?, jobId?, kind, level, message, dataJson, durationMs}` written from poll status transitions and the failure branch, plus ledger debits and feedback; `GET /api/vater/me/log` behind a new "System log" screen; failures alert Telegram (deduped per job). Add `@sentry/nextjs` free tier + `instrumentation.ts` — remember `log.ts` is a production no-op today.
- ☐ **Publishing.** Ungate `social-accounts/oauth/youtube/start` for card-on-file users and move the Connect button onto the PublishingScreen tiles. Library gets "Send to scheduler" — copy the Blob URL now, optional **Postiz self-host on the DGX** later.
- ☐ **Custom voices for beta users.** Open `POST /api/vater/voices` to card-on-file users with a **cap of 2** and a consent checkbox; namespace `vater_voices/<userId>/` and `characters/<userId>/` on the DGX (`vater.py:57,1805,3381`) so user #2 stops colliding with user #1.
- ☐ **Guardrails.** Beta cap **9:00** — reject scripts over **1,700 words** at both from-script and context entry points; default **5:00**; QA re-roll budget becomes `max(20, 15% of scenes)`; pin `defaultPacingSec=4`; promote the page-5 default rule set into the planner block for every non-Trey style.

Phase 4 · Homepage, demos & GTM · Verification

Days 4–7, then the proof that it all works — and the four things only you can do.

PHASE 4 Make it sellable

days 4–7

- ☐ **Rewrite** `AnimateLanding.tsx`. A **"PUBLIC BETA · INVITE ONLY"** badge; hero line *"Type a script. Get a finished faceless video for ~\$1/min."*; **3–4 real demo <video> cards** served from `Blob demos/` copies — #23 now, #19/#22/#16 once Trey signs; a feature grid (script writer, custom voice + tuner, library, 7-step editor, upload, YouTube publish, scheduler hand-off, automation coming); an à-la-carte pricing block (\$0.35/min + compute at cost, typical \$1–7/video, packs, no subscription, date-stamped competitor \$/min table with footnote); an honest free-starter line (\$10 promo credit, card on file, no watermark, downloadable); ToS/privacy/beta links, version pill, feedback link. **Delete the fake "\$24.85" card and "NO CARD REQUIRED"**.
- ☐ **One price everywhere**. Copy sweep across `help-content.ts:55-64`, `PricingScreen.tsx`, `BetaAccessBanner.tsx`, `Header.tsx:105`, `BillingBlock.tsx`, `DashboardScreen.tsx:160`, and the `app/animate/page.tsx:20` metadata.
- ☐ **Mobile**. Extend `tests/e2e/audit/animate.spec.ts` to editor steps 0–6 and the `StyleWizardModal` at **390 px**; fix the grids at `ScriptStep.tsx:482`, `VisualsStep.tsx:1017`, `StyleWizardModal.tsx:1063`.
- ☐ **GTM kit** — Jared executes, queued to /hq Must Complete. Create the **"Jelly Studio" Facebook Page** under the existing Meta Business account; run the **\$150 Meta traffic campaign** (Reels + Feed, AI label on creative, \$10–15/day, landing on an invite-request page); wire the invite-request form into Must Complete; DM scripts for Trey (3 referrals + consent) and the warm network (10); rules-compliant Discord and Reddit posts offering invite-by-DM; **3 TikTok demo clips a week**; free Product Hunt and Show HN in week 2; optional Fiverr gig.
- ☐ **Modal**. Raise the workspace budget-cap alert; stay on Starter for ≤ 5 users; queue the Team-plan decision at more than 4 concurrent renders.

VERIFY How we prove it works

before invites go out

- ☐ **Walk the golden path for real**. Extend the Playwright harness to a **write-enabled** run against a preview/staging DB (or production with a `beta-audit@` invite code): signup with code → ToS → card (Stripe test) → buy \$10 pack → create style → project → render (**confirm Modal-only via job kwargs**) → receipt → feedback → view-as. Assert **zero cross-tenant reads** — a second account must not fetch the first's project, job, or voice.
- ☐ **Negative tests by curl** from a plain account against pipeline-status, the jobs proxy and voices DELETE; confirm `register` returns **409** for the owner's admin email.
- ☐ **Trey's money is unchanged**. `node scripts/vater-invoice.mjs --summary` must match after scoping; one test video's ledger debit must equal its receipt; the Stripe dashboard must show the pack payment; review the `vercel env pull` diff.
- ☐ **DGX behaviour**. Three concurrent test renders — the **fourth must queue**; **no** `vater_runway.clear()` anywhere in the journal; earlyoom left untouched.
- ☐ **This brief**. Page-fit and link check on /hq; TLDR sent to Telegram as a link.

JARED Open items — queued, not blocking the build

/hq Must Complete

- ☐ **Trey**: collect written reuse consent for #19, #22 and #16 — and ask for **3 referrals** in the same conversation.
- ☐ **Stripe**: confirm the production webhook is subscribed to `checkout.session.completed`, `invoice.paid` and `invoice.payment_failed`.
- ☐ **Legal**: DMCA agent registration (**\$6**, dmca.copyright.gov) and an optional 1-hour attorney review (~\$300) of the arbitration and showcase clauses.
- ☐ **Marketing**: create the Jelly Studio Facebook Page and approve the **\$150** Meta budget.

Target — five paying users by August 31, 2026, on tolley.io/animate, profitable per minute, with nothing customer-facing sending itself

5 by 8/31

How this was produced: a 15-agent read-only research swarm — 12 finders and 3 adversarial verifiers — run Aug 15, 2026 across ~1.5M tokens and 613 tool calls. Nothing in production was modified. Every claim traces to live code, live Stripe and Modal data, or measured render history; the verifiers' job was to disprove the finders. Source HTML: `scripts/briefs/jelly-beta-launch-2026-08.html`.